TOOL GUIDE · HACKING

Hacking-Chips // Cryptokeys

Which cryptokeys exist, how good they are, what you hack and how to use them.
Values are patch-dependent — check live.

00 Basics

A **cryptokey** is a **portable hacking chip** used to crack secured electronic systems. It is a **consumable** (used up on use).

WHAT	USED ON	TRADE-OFF	CONSUMABLE
hacking chip	comm arrays, crime stat, doors/terminals	speed vs. error risk	yes (patch-dep.)

HOW TO READ **Hack time %** = share of base duration → **lower = faster**. **Error chance** = risk the hack fails (chip usually still consumed). Ideal: low time **and** low error.

Note: some sources list multiple "charges" for certain chips (e.g. Tigersclaw 3). This is patch-sensitive — treat as single-use when in doubt and verify in game.

01 The chips compared

CHIP	MAKER	HACK TIME	ERROR	VERDICT
Decryption Key	unknown	100%	0%	slow but never fails — safest
Re-Authorizer	Lortell	100%	10%	normal & reliable
FUNT	unknown	50%	10%	fast & reliable — top all-rounder

CHIP	MAKER	HACK TIME	ERROR	VERDICT
Tigersclaw	Blue Triangle	75%	50%	solid standard, often looted
IcePick	microTech	50%	50%	fast but risky
Ripper	unknown	50%	90%	very fast, highly unstable (Tigersclaw mod)

PICK **Critical hack (crime stat, one-shot door)?** → **Decryption Key** (0% error) or **FUNT** (fast & safe). **Many hacks/time pressure & stock on hand?** → fast but risky chips (IcePick/Ripper) only with spares.

02 What can you hack?

- **Remove crime stat:** wipe your own wanted level at the **Imperial Criminal Database** (classically **Security Post Kareah**).
- **Comm-Arrays:** hack/disable comm array terminals — e.g. to go "dark" (no reinforcements/crime report) or for mission steps.
- **Doors, terminals & containers:** open locked access in **bunkers**, facilities, exec/contested-zone areas, and secured data terminals (loot access).

Officially confirmed: comm arrays & Imperial Criminal Database. Doors/terminals/containers are common practice but vary by location & patch.

03 How to use

1. Carry a suitable chip in your **inventory**.
2. Go to the hackable **terminal/panel** (Kareah terminal, comm array console, bunker door/terminal).
3. **F** to interact → the chip is inserted and the hack runs (duration depends on chip).

4. On **success**: access granted (door open / crime stat cleared / array down). On **failure** (error chance): hack fails, chip usually consumed → use another.

> WARNING Hacking often leaves you **exposed** (standing at the terminal) and can **generate a crime stat** (e.g. on others' systems/comm arrays). Always carry **spare chips**, especially with high error chance.

04 Where to get them

BUY

- **Technotic** — Grim HEX
- **Grand Barter Bazaar** — Levski
- **Cubby Blast** — Area18
- **Omega Pro** & **The Factory Line** — New Babbage

LOOT

Hacking chips (esp. Tigersclaw) appear in container loot in **bunkers** and facilities — handy, since you often need one on the spot to proceed.

LOOK UP LIVE

- SC-Wiki — Cryptokeys: starcitizen.tools
- CStone Item-Finder (Hacking Chips): finder.cstone.space

Unofficial, not affiliated with CIG. Star Citizen® is a trademark of CIG. Values & locations are patch-dependent — no guarantee.